

1598
June 30

[p. 64]

and to re-examine the matter before the Council. Which was adjudged by the whole Court to be a heinous offence against the Queen and her dignity, against the common justice of the land, and a slander of the same, and a great defamation of the Lord Chief Justice of England; and he [the Lord Chief Justice] was acquitted of this, and discharged, and delivered with very much and very great fame, commendation, credit, reputation and honour, and by all adjudged to be the most grave, wise and just judge that ever before had possessed his place; and as to the trial itself, Lord Anderson, the Recorder of London, Barnes and Crompton,¹ reported in the hearing of the Court, that it was the most just that could be; inasmuch as the prisoner had a copy of the indictment (which he could not have without the warrant of the Queen's Counsel) and of the examinations of the witnesses on both sides, as well to acquit him as to accuse him, and he was reprieved also for many days. And S^r Edwarde Carewe confessed (being present at the said trial), that if he himself had been of the Jury, he would, on the same evidence, have condemned him, which aggravates and increases the offence now in question. And it was said by the Lord Keeper that if the Chief Justice had been found guilty of this offence, in the first place, he would draw the vengeance of God on all the land for innocent blood, he had abused the Queen and her justice, for she is the body and we are the parts of the body, and it is her continual charge "Serue not mee in knowledge, wisdom or eloquence, but serue mee in the Feare of god, & doe Justice equallye to all my subiectes in the feare of god." And this would have been his punishment, as the precedent is 24 Edward III.: Sir William Thorpe, Chief Justice of England, was accused of taking bribes; whereupon the King directed a grave Commission of the most honourable lords of the land, who examined the matter, and found him guilty of taking of one £10, of

¹ Probably two barristers who had been present at the trial. Crompton's name is given by Foss in a list of

Counsel during Queen Elizabeth's reign. Barnes is not mentioned.